

# The Cosmere Reading Order

Sanderson says there's no single mandatory Cosmere order — several books work as entry points. This is the spoiler-conscious path: Mistborn Era 1 first, Secret History only after The Bands of Mourning (his own rule — it torpedoed Era 1 otherwise), Warbreaker before Words of Radiance for a quiet payoff, and The Sunlit Man last. Notes flag the slots that are genuinely flexible. (The Frugal Wizard's Handbook isn't Cosmere, so it isn't here.)

■ MISTBORN — ERA 1 ■ MISTBORN — ERA 2 ■ THE STORMLIGHT ARCHIVE ■ STANDALONES & NOVELLAS

- ☐ Mistborn: The Final Empire
- ☐ The Well of Ascension
- ☐ The Hero of Ages
- ☐ Tress of the Emerald Sea  
flexible — works any time after Mistborn Era 1
- ☐ The Alloy of Law
- ☐ Shadows of Self
- ☐ The Bands of Mourning
- ☐ Mistborn: Secret History  
Sanderson's rule: only after The Bands of Mourning — massive Era 1 spoilers
- ☐ Warbreaker  
read before Words of Radiance for a payoff; free ebook on Sanderson's site
- ☐ Elantris  
flexible — Sanderson's first novel, readable anywhere
- ☐ The Emperor's Soul  
Hugo-winning novella in the Elantris world
- ☐ The Way of Kings
- ☐ Words of Radiance
- ☐ Edgedancer  
novella — read before Oathbringer
- ☐ Oathbringer
- ☐ Dawnshard  
novella — read before Rhythm of War
- ☐ Rhythm of War
- ☐ Yumi and the Nightmare Painter  
best after Rhythm of War
- ☐ The Lost Metal  
heavy Cosmere crossover — lands hardest this late in the path
- ☐ Wind and Truth
- ☐ The Sunlit Man  
read last — it follows Stormlight's endgame